

مرسم

Marsam – identity system

لعب إبداعي مستوحى من السعودية

Creative play inspired by Saudi Arabia

Status: a proposal for parent language testing, not a locked identity. The decision brief forbids locking the name, logo, palette or font system before the Sept 7-18 sessions. Everything here is versioned and swappable in one command (`rename-brand.sh`). Put it in front of parents; do not print it on anything yet.

Principles

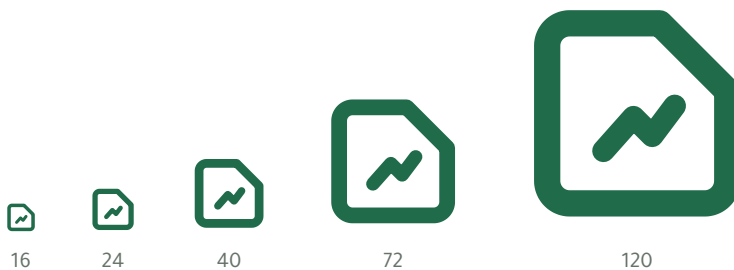
- The palette must survive being coloured on. Line art is the product; brand colour sits next to a child's crayon work and must not fight it.
- Saudi green anchors the system but must not dominate every page.
- Warm, curious, contemporary, respectful, child-capable. Never academic, preachy, touristy, ceremonial-only or babyish.
- Arabic-first and genuinely bilingual. One type family carrying both scripts, not a Latin face with Arabic bolted on.
- No flag, emblem, official mark, or any arrangement implying endorsement.

The mark

A sheet whose top corner has come away, holding the space a child fills. It is the product described in one shape: tear-out, single-sided, and the child's mark is the point.



IT HAS TO HOLD AT 16PX



Minimum 14mm in print, 40px on screen for the lockup, and 16px for the mark alone.

CLEAR SPACE



One cap-height of the Arabic wordmark on all four sides. Nothing enters it, including the edge of the sheet.

NEVER

- Do not place the mark on artwork, or on any surface a child colours.
- Do not recolour the mark outside ink, palm green, or reversed to paper.
- Do not stretch, rotate, outline, add effects, or lock it to another logo.
- Do not use the Latin wordmark alone in Saudi-facing material.

- Do not set the mark beside any official symbol, emblem or flag.

Colour

Never place brand colour behind line art. The child's colour must be the brightest thing on the page.

CORE

#1F2D27

حبر

INK

All body text, line art, the default dark. A near-black with green in it, so it sits with the anchor rather than against it.

#1F6B4A

أخضر النخيل

PALM GREEN

The anchor. Headings, primary buttons, the mark. Roughly 10-15% of any surface – never a full-bleed field behind artwork.

#FAF7F1

ورق

PAPER

The default ground everywhere. Warm, not white – it makes uncoated stock look intentional rather than cheap.

#FFFFFF

أبيض

SHEET WHITE

Cards, the printed sheet itself. Reserved, so it reads as 'the product' against paper.

ACCENT

#C8763C

طين

TERRACOTTA

The second voice. Difficulty icons, talk-together prompts, highlights. Carries warmth the green cannot.

#E8D9C5

صلصال

CLAY

Quiet fills, panel backgrounds, the calm behind a callout.

#4A8FA8

#C25B6E

بحر

SEA

The cool balance. Reef and sea content, informational states.

ورد

TAIF ROSE

Springly. Seasonal capsules, gift packaging.

#E5D5B8

رمل

SAND

Dividers, secondary rules, packaging bands.

#AD6230

طين – للنص

TERRACOTTA, TEXT

Terracotta when it must carry words. The bright #C8763C is a graphic colour for icons, rules and marks; it only clears 2.5:1 on clay, so it never sets text on a warm ground.

NEUTRAL

#4A5A52

SOFT

Secondary text

#667269

MUTED

Tertiary text, captions, and the English line beneath every Arabic line. 4.70:1 on paper – the earlier #8B958F sat at 2.89:1 and failed everything.

#E5DED1

LINE

Rules, borders, table lines

RULES

- Green and terracotta never occupy equal area. One leads, one accents, and green leads by default.
- Rose and sea are capsule and category colours, not brand colours. They must not appear on the masterbrand mark.
- Every colour pairing used for text must clear the contrast table in the guidelines before it ships.

- Terracotta has two values on purpose: the bright one is a graphic colour, the darker one is a text colour. Using the graphic value for words is the most likely way this palette fails an audit.

Contrast – measured, not asserted

Computed at build time from the tokens. **AA** clears 4.5:1 for body text; **AA large** clears 3:1 for text at 24px, or 19px bold, and for icons. Anything marked **no** must never carry text.

	PAPER	SHEET WHITE	PALM GREEN	INK	CLAY
INK	13.4 AA	14.4 AA	2.2 NO	—	10.4 AA
GREEN	6.0 AA	6.4 AA	—	2.2 NO	4.7 AA
TERRACOTTA	3.2 AA LARGE	3.4 AA LARGE	1.9 NO	4.2 AA LARGE	2.5 NO
SOFT	6.8 AA	7.3 AA	1.1 NO	2.0 NO	5.3 AA
MUTED	4.7 AA	5.0 AA	1.3 NO	2.9 NO	3.6 AA LARGE
WHITE	1.1 NO	—	6.4 AA	14.4 AA	1.4 NO
PAPER	—	1.1 NO	6.0 AA	13.4 AA	1.3 NO
SKY	3.4 AA LARGE	3.6 AA LARGE	1.8 NO	4.0 AA LARGE	2.6 NO
ROSE	3.9 AA LARGE	4.2 AA LARGE	1.5 NO	3.4 AA LARGE	3.0 AA LARGE

Auditing this found a real defect in work already shipped: the English secondary line sat at 2.4-2.9:1 across the landing pages, emails, prototype sheets and field-pack forms. It is the second reading of every bilingual line in the system, so it was the worst possible place to be unreadable. Fixed to #667269 at 4.7:1.

Type

Tajawal – One family carrying Arabic and Latin with the same voice. The brief demands genuine bilingualism, and pairing an Arabic face with an unrelated Latin one is how 'Arabic added as decoration' happens in practice.

لَوْن. اِكتشف.
أبدع.

DISPLAY

Color.

Discover.

Create.

clamp(2rem,
6vw,
3.4rem)
800

Hero, cover

لَوْن. اِكتشف. أبدع.

H1

Color. Discover.

Create.

1.75rem
800

Page and section titles

لَوْن. اِكتشف. أبدع.

H2

Color. Discover. Create.

1.25rem
700

Subsections

لَوْن. اِكتشف. أبدع.

BODY

Color. Discover. Create.

1.0625rem
400

Everything readable

لَوْن. اِكتشف. أبدع.

SMALL

Color. Discover. Create.

0.875rem
400

Captions, specifications

BILINGUAL RULES

- Arabic first, always: above, or to the right, never below the English.
- English sits at 82-85% of the Arabic size and in a muted tone. It is the second reading, not a caption.
- Never mirror an Arabic line into a Latin layout by flipping it. Set RTL properly and check on a device.
- Outline all Arabic before print output. Shaping and diacritics break at RIP, not on screen.
- Arabic-Indic numerals on the product; Latin numerals wherever a number must be machine-read.

Applications

ألوان السعودية

COLORS OF SAUDI ARABIA



Pad cover – mark small, title leading, paper ground

لَوْن. اِكتشف. اُبدع.

COLOR. DISCOVER. CREATE.

Packaging band – the one place green may dominate



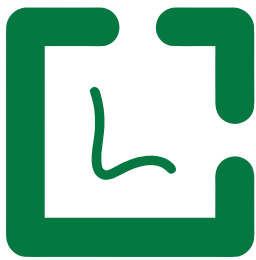
أحسنْتَ!

Well done

Completion sticker – clay ground, mark in a white disc

Marks considered

Six generated explorations, kept so the reasoning is visible rather than lost. They are exploration, not candidates: the proposal above is hand-drawn on an 8-unit grid, which is the one asset where provenance has to be unambiguous.



Window and mark

On-concept – the page and the child's mark. The strongest of the six generated, but the interior squiggle is loose where the rest is geometric.



Palm frond

Warm, but reads as a sunburst as much as a frond, and botanical marks are crowded in this category.



Arch

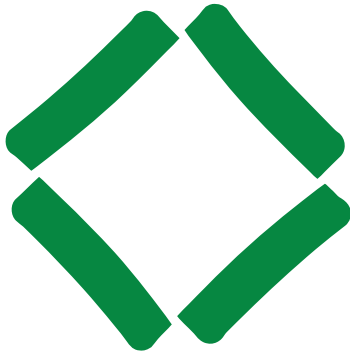
Rejected.



Lifting page

Reads as a mihrab. The editorial rules bar religious architecture as a brand device, and this is not a judgement to make late.

Abstract to the point of saying nothing. Reads as a bird or a sail before it reads as paper.



Four strokes

Clean, distinctive, holds small. The least literal and the most ownable – worth testing against the proposal.



Stepped sprout

Growth without the usual softness. Credible, but growth metaphors are heavily worked in education branding.

What to test on 7 September

Show the six marks on one card, no colour, no name, and ask what kind of company each sounds like *before* saying what yours does. Then the disqualifying question: is there any of these you would not buy from? Negative reactions are far more diagnostic than preferences.

Two specific questions this system cannot answer on its own:

- Does the mark read as a page, or as a chart? The interior stroke is confident, which is the point, but confidence and 'analytics icon' are neighbours.
- Does palm green read as warm or as institutional? It anchors the system, and the brief warns against ceremonial-only associations.